
MEETING MINUTES

The Thirteenth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

September 9, 2024

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 7/0
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Good of the Order
- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Approval of Bills and Payrolls
 - Approval of Capital Purchases
 - Approval of Meeting Minutes

- Regular Meeting Minutes, **June 10, 2024**
- Special Meeting Minutes, **June 24, 2024**
- Special Meeting Minutes, **July 3, 2024**
- Special Meeting Minutes, **July 24, 2024**
- Special Meeting Minutes, **July 31, 2024**
- Special Meeting Minutes, **August 21, 2024**

Motion to Approve Consent Agenda with Special Meeting June 24, 2024 minutes as amended by Member Ruseau, second by Member Intoppa - 7/0 passed

Motion to table Capital Purchases by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

- V. Report of Subcommittees - None
- VI. Report of the Superintendent
 - 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 - 2. **Recommendation to Approve** \$35,000 grant from the Cummings Foundation to the Center for Citizenship and Social Responsibility (CCSR) for the 2024-2025 school year. - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Motion to Approve by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passed

- 3. **Recommendation to Approve** \$50,000 grant from Ernie Boch Jr. Music Drives Us Organization to the Roberts Elementary School - Ms. Michelle Crowell, Principal of Roberts Elementary

Motion to Approve by Member Intoppa, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passed

- 4. **Recommendation to Approve** \$200,000 grant from the Barr Foundation to Medford High School - Ms. Marta Cabral, Principal of Medford High School

Motion to Approve by Member Ruseau, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passed

5. **Recommendation to Approve** a field trip for the Culinary Arts Program to visit Johnson and Wales University in Rhode Island - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent

Motion to Approve by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passed

6. **Report on Summer Programming** - Dr. Suzanne B. Galusi, Assistant Superintendent; Ms. Joan Bowen, Director of Pupil Services; Ms. Suzanne Fee, Director of Fine Arts (not in attendance); Mr. Paul Teixeira, Director of EL and Ms. Marta Cabral, Principal of Medford High School
7. **Report on Personnel and Enrollment**- Dr. Suzanne B. Galusi, Assistant Superintendent

Action Item - Request to send the Committee the October DESE report via email and also quarterly going forward with Medford High School and Vocational Technical High School separated.

Joanne McKay, Roberts Elementary Third Grade Teacher spoke on enrollment asking that we begin the process of redistricting for FY 25-26.

8. **Report on Operations** - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent

Motion to have the capital planning subcommittee makes a plan for electrification across the district by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham- 7/0 passed

Motion to approve Capital Purchases for the Brooks Elementary by Member Ruseau, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passed

- McGlynn Playground Ribbon Cutting - October 8, 2024 @ 3:30 pm
- Transportation - District requesting additional buses, driver shortage confirmed by bus company to the Superintendent. Sixteen new drivers were hired, 12 resigned two weeks before school started with finding employment elsewhere. District will continue to work on solutions.

Christine Gulla, 116 Exchange Street spoke on a recent transportation memo that went out to families and the dilemma the shortage is causing.

Andrea, 42 Gayle Street spoke on the same topic.

Ilene Lerner, 9 Adams Circle thanked the District for their hard work and offered her opinion that the schools need more money to better serve the students.

Presentations of the Public - None

VII. Continued Business - None

VIII. New Business

2024-31

Offered by: Member Ruseau

First Reading of Policy AC - Non-Discrimination Including Harassment and Retaliation

The Medford School Committee and the Medford Public Schools are committed to maintaining an education and work environment for all school community members free from all forms of discrimination, including harassment and retaliation. The school community members include the School Committee, employees, administration, faculty, staff, students, volunteers in the schools, and parties contracted to perform work for the Medford Public Schools.

The Medford Public Schools does not exclude from participation, deny the benefits of the Medford Public Schools from or otherwise discriminate against individuals on the basis of race*, color, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, sex stereotypes, sex characteristics, religion, disability, age, genetic information, active military/veteran status, marital status, familial status, pregnancy, or pregnancy-related condition, housing status, ancestry, ethnic background, national origin, or any other category protected by state or federal law in the administration of its educational and employment policies, or in its programs and activities.

This commitment to the community is affirmed by the following statements. The School Committee commits to:

1. Promoting the rights and responsibilities of all individuals as set forth in the State and Federal Constitutions, pertinent legislation, and applicable judicial interpretations.
2. Encouraging positive experiences in human values for children, youth, and adults, all of whom have differing personal and family characteristics and come from various socioeconomic, racial, and ethnic groups.
3. Working toward a more integrated society and enlisting the support of individuals as well as groups and agencies, both private and governmental, in such an effort.
4. Using all appropriate communication and action techniques to air and address the grievances of individuals and groups.
5. Carefully consider, in all the decisions made within the school district, the potential benefits or adverse consequences of those decisions on human relations.
6. Initiating a process of reviewing policies and practices of the school district to achieve, to the greatest extent possible, the objectives of this statement.

The Medford Public Schools requires all members of the school community to conduct themselves in accordance with this policy.

It shall be a violation of this policy for any member of the school community to engage in any form of discrimination, including harassment and retaliation, or to violate any other civil right of any member of the school community. We recognize that discrimination can take a range of forms and can be targeted or unintentional; however, discrimination in any form, including harassment and retaliation, will not be tolerated.

It shall also be a violation of this policy for any school community member to subject any other member of the school community to any form of retaliation, including, but not limited to, coercion, intimidation, interference, punishment, discrimination, or harassment for reporting or filing a complaint of discrimination, cooperating in an investigation, aiding or encouraging another member of the school community to report such conduct or file a complaint, or opposing any act or practice reasonably believed to be prohibited by this policy.

*race to include traits historically associated with race, including, but not limited to, hair texture, hair type, hair length, and protective hairstyles.

Policy Information

First Adopted: Unknown

Last Amended: TBD

Last Reviewed: TBD

Review Frequency: five (5) years

Next Review: TBD

Version: 2

Policy ID: AC

Original Source: MASC - July 2024

Legal References:

Title VI, Civil Rights Act of 1964

Title VII, Civil Rights Act of 1964, as amended by the Equal Employment Opportunity Act of 1972 Executive Order 11246, as amended by E.O. 11375

Equal Pay Act, as amended by the Education Amendments of 1972 Title IX, Education Amendments of 1972

Rehabilitation Act of 1973

Education for All Handicapped Children Act of 1975

No Child Left Behind Act of 2001, 20 U.S.C. § 7905 (The Boy Scouts of America Equal Access Act)

M.G.L. [71B:1](#) et seq. (Chapter 766 of the Acts of 1972)

M.G.L. [117](#)

Cross References:

[ACE](#), Nondiscrimination on the Basis of Disability

[ACAB](#), Harassment

[ACAB-R](#), Policy Prohibiting Sexual Harassment and Violence

[GBA](#), Equal Employment Opportunity

[II](#), Instructional Materials

[JB](#), Equal Educational Opportunities

Date Submitted: 9/3/2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: 9/9/2024

Motion to Approve by Member Ruseau, second by Member Intoppa - 7/0 passed

- Put on September 23, 2024 agenda for second reading,

2024 -32 Offered by: Member Ruseau

Policy BEDB III. Consent Agenda will have ', Grant Approvals, Field Trip Approvals ' added after 'Approval of Bills'.

Date Submitted: 9/4/2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: 9/9/2024

Motion to approve by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Intoppa - 7/0 passed

Motion to waive second reading by Member Ruseau, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passed

IX. Reports Requested - None

X. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Helen A. Gogolos**, a retired cafeteria worker for Medford Public Schools.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **John J. Bailey Jr.**, husband of former Medford Public School teacher Janice Bailey and father to Medford's Recreation Director, Kevin Bailey.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Joseph Tortora**, grandfather of Anthony Tortora who is part of our District Tech Support Team.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Dr. Melvyn Levine**, father of Ian Levine of the Andrews Middle School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Robin Irving**, a McGlynn Middle School teacher and Medford Public Schools employee for over 40+ years.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Pauline Lenox Davis**, aunt of former Mayor, Michael J. McGlynn and Karen McGlynn Devine. *Our sincerest apologies for the original misprint.*

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Cesar A. Gomez**, father of Brooks Elementary staff member Loren Gomez. Mr. Gomez was a US Veteran and passed away just before his 100th birthday.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Wede Fegerson "Wade" Desir**, who was a Class of 2019 Robotics and Engineering Mustang graduate of the Medford Vocational Technical High School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Francis P. “Frank” Zizzo**, father of middle school teacher Frankie Zizzo and uncle of high school teachers Brittani Lanzilli and Kayli Lanzilli.

XI. Next Regular Meeting

September 23, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Mayor Lungo-Koehn, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passed
Meeting adjourned at 8:55 pm